11 To grip the tenon was a much easier task. I mounted a scrap block of timber in a chuck and cut a recess of 25mm diameter, deep enough to accept the tenon already cut on the existing pedestal so once fitted between centres, friction would take over and allow the pedestal to be reworked

12 The existing pedestal was now in place and ready for refining

13 The reworked pedestal with added details and refinements, keeping in mind my concern to not override the aesthetics of the original maker

14 Sanded to completion, it was divided into three sections with the aid of the lathe's indexing head so mortises could be created to accept the three feet

15 The feet had already been cut but were in need of refinement, tenons needed trimming on a bandsaw and curves enhanced

16 Unfortunately each of the tenons was of a different width but I opted to leave them this way as the thinnest was too thin for my liking and I was concerned about how strong the joint would eventually be

17 Profiles were further refined on an oscillating spindle sander. Edges were eased and then rounded during the hand sanding stage. It was time-consuming but worth it as you can see from the improvements in the completed shape

18 Mortises were drilled on a pedestal drill to remove as much waste material as possible. Note that a supporting 'V' block was used to allow alignment of the wood and to prevent it from rolling while drilling

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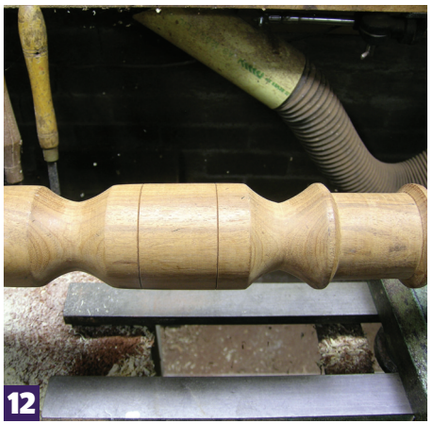
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HANDY HINTS

3. Be prepared to think laterally on a project like this one, you'll need to come up with simple ways to rechuck near completed forms
4. Be prepared to go outside your comfort zone when taking on another person's tastes and aesthetics. I've certainly learnt a lesson from this project and am tempted to make my own pedestal table
5. Vernier callipers are essential in determining diameters of tenons, depths of holes and thicknesses of tenons. For many years I've relied on the most simple form of this tool, but now I also use a digital set

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